WEAVING A BRIGHTER TOMORROW

National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT), the frontrunner in fashion education, has been instrumental in taking India's fashion industry to the global level as well as contributing to the nation-building. The premier Institute has multifarious approach that integrates global vision with grassroots connect

National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT) was made a statutory institute in 2006 by an Act of Parliament, that is, NIFT Act, 2006. Over the years NIFT has expanded its wings pan-India spanning 17 campuses in different states. As a pioneering institute in fashion education, NIFT is providing a cutting-edge learning experience to its students. It is the result of its constant and persistent efforts that NIFT has been ranked at number nine amongst fashion institutes of the world.

As part of its constant efforts to reinvent and re-evaluate itself and introduce the latest in the field of technology keeping the needs of the industry in mind, the curriculum of NIFT covers subjects of digital intervention such as Artificial Intelligence, Big Data and Business Analytics, Internet of Things, Digital Embroidery, Laser & 3D Printing, Augmented Reality, Virtual Experience design; as well as specialised subjects of fashion expertise such as Smart Jewellery, Smart Textiles, Ergonomic Design Environment, Fashion Thinking, Sensory Design, Optitex for Virtual Prototyping, Surface Embellishment and Design Strategy.

In a nutshell, the academic curriculum incorporates internships, industry visits, outbound programmes as well as real life projects, seminars and interactions. All these activities provide opportunities for students to appreciate and understand the working of the industry. Among these, the Craft Cluster Activities are one of the most important and integral part of NIFT's curricula which fuse the Unique Craft Cluster Initiative programme of the Ministry of Textiles with the academic programmes to sensitise the students about their rich craft heritage. Recently, NIFT has laid a special focus on GI registered crafts of India.

NIFT's international and domestic linkages facilitate processes whereby faculty at NIFT participates in academic exchange programs, international fairs, seminars, exhibitions, conferences and trade shows which bring substantial exposure to students and enrich their knowledge. The faculty at NIFT is the strategic enabler in transforming the vision of the Institute into reality.

Since its inception NIFT has to its credit more than 35000 Alumni working with the industry in key decision-making positions and they have been instrumental in shaping the future of fashion business as change agents in India and abroad. They are working at various levels in more than 2000 organisations across the world as Brand Managers, Quality Controllers, Designers, Fashion Coordinators, Merchandisers, Production Managers, and Marketing Heads, among others in leading national and international organisations.

Not only this, but several NIFT alumni have become entrepreneurs and successful brands themselves such as Ritu Beri, Sabyasachi Mukherji, to name a few. Over the years, NIFT has also been working as a knowledge service provider to the Union and State governments in the area of design development and positioning of handlooms and handicrafts.

Riding on its previous experiences, NIFT has recently taken up some unique projects like project 'India Size' and 'VisioNXT' in the field of fashion research for the country. The project 'India Size' intends to develop size charts on the lines of US size and UK sizes that are currently prevalent in the industry. 'India Size' would establish size charts for Indian body types considering the country's topography & diversity. The project 'VisioNXT' projects on the other hand, is one of its kind 'Trend insight and Fashion Forecasting Lab' to forecast India's fashion to suit future trends.

Under the aegis of NIFT, a textile and craft repository is being developed as a knowledge portal for textiles, crafts & clothing to preserve and promote Indian textiles and crafts, and collate, showcase and share results of craft cluster activities on a single platform. NIFT is also setting up design resource centres at Weavers Service Centres' for DC (Handlooms), besides developing a digital platform for craft-based enterprises for the Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology (Meity).

With its multifarious approach, integrating global vision with grassroots connect, NIFT has become an agent of change in the field of fashion education. It has emerged as a driving force in nation building by imparting international standard fashion education to the youth, integrating knowledge, academic freedom, critical independence and creative thinking.





